inevitable. Accordingly, a prominent group of ASEAN parliamentarians have argued that there is a need to abandon the traditional stance of non-interference in the affairs of member states and are demanding that Myanmar allows international observers into Rakhine and restores at least basic civil rights for the Rohingyas.[104] The rest of the international community would do well to back the current ASEAN initiatives.

Finally, there is a small but brave and committed, civil society movement in Myanmar. Directly backing this would probably do more harm than good since its participants would inevitably then be branded as stooges of external powers.[105] However, noting their importance and being less adulatory towards the NLD would send a powerful signal that the human rights of all those who live in Myanmar matter—not just those of particular ethnic or religious groups.

Myanmar now stands on the edge of genocide.[106] The Rohingyas have nothing left, most live in internal refugee camps[107] and they are denied basic health care and the ability to work. Due to these deliberate pressures they look to flee;[108] and many in the regime, of the regional Rakhine establishment and among the Buddhist extremists are keen to encourage them to do so—so keen that the use of violence to trigger a final exodus cannot be ruled out. This is genocide:[109] it is the deliberate destruction of an identified ethnic group. International indifference only encourages the regime to believe it can get away with it.